

BuildFlow — Product PRD

Construction operations, made visible.

A mobile-first app for small construction contractors. It handles attendance, daily site reports, materials and wages for all their sites in one place.

Version / Date	v1.1 · 1 October 2026
Owner	Product & Engineering
Market	India-first · contractors with 2–20 active sites
Status	For team alignment — what to build and why

1. Problem / Opportunity

1.1 The Problem

Small contractors run their sites on paper registers, Excel, phone calls and WhatsApp. The data exists, but it reaches the office late, sits in many places, and cannot be checked.

Who	What goes wrong today
Owner	Cannot see what happened on his sites today. Hears about problems days later, on a call.
Accountant	Attendance is incomplete or argued over. He re-types the register into Excel every pay cycle.
Store / materials	Material received and material used are hard to match, so waste and theft go unnoticed.
Supervisor	Writes the same data three times — register, WhatsApp, Excel — on a weak network, so records stay incomplete.
Worker	Has no record of his own attendance, overtime or advance, so pay day turns into an argument.

1.2 The Opportunity

- **Big market, still on paper.** Lakhs of Indian contractors run 2–20 sites by hand. Cheap Android phones and cheap data now make a digital field record possible.
- **Nobody has won this segment.** ERP and BIM suites are built for large companies. Attendance apps do not understand how a construction site works.
- **A daily record is a foothold.** Once BuildFlow is the trusted daily record of a site, it can grow into wages, materials, payments and integrations.

2. Target Users & Use Cases

User	Who they are	What they need to do
Contractor / Owner	Runs the company. Manages 2–20 sites and subcontractors.	See every site each day. Approve exceptions. Check wages and material summaries.

User	Who they are	What they need to do
Project Manager	Looks after several supervisors and sites.	Read daily reports. Fix exceptions. Chase missing data.
Site Supervisor	On site all day. Low-cost Android phone. Often no network.	Check in. Mark attendance. File a daily report. Record materials. Flag blockers.
Accountant	Sits in the office. Lives in Excel and the accounting software.	Turn approved attendance into a wage summary. Export data. Track payments.
Worker (future)	Daily-wage or monthly site labour.	Not a login user in the MVP. Later: check his own attendance and wages.

2.1 Critical User Journeys (CUJs)

Section 6 groups every requirement under one of these six journeys.

CUJ	Journey	Stage
CUJ-1	Set up a company, sites, team and workers	First-time setup
CUJ-2	Start the day — check in and mark attendance	Daily use
CUJ-3	End the day — daily report and materials	Daily use
CUJ-4	Prepare the wage summary	Weekly / monthly
CUJ-5	Review sites, approve records, fix mistakes	Maintain
CUJ-6	Offboard people, archive sites, export data	Retire / exit

3. Current Journeys / Landscape

3.1 How It Works Today

Step	What happens
1	Supervisor writes attendance and work details in a paper register.
2	He sends a photo or a message to the office on WhatsApp. Doubts are cleared on a call.
3	The accountant re-types everything into Excel at the end of the week or month.
4	The owner calls each supervisor to ask what happened. There is no one place to look.
5	At wage time, the office and the workers argue over whose record is correct.

The result: the same data is entered two or three times, decisions are made on old information, wages are disputed, and material loss is never spotted.

3.2 What They Could Use Instead

Alternative	Why it does not stick
Paper + Excel + WhatsApp	Free and familiar. But scattered, unverifiable, no single view, and no record of who changed what.

Alternative	Why it does not stick
Construction ERP / BIM suites	Powerful but costly and complex. Built for office staff in large firms. Need good internet and long training.
Generic attendance apps	They do punch-in and punch-out. They miss many sites, trades, daily progress, materials and offline work.

The gap: a simple, mobile-first, offline-first daily record made for construction sites. This is where BuildFlow starts.

4. Proposed Solution

4.1 Elevator Pitch

BuildFlow is a mobile app with a web dashboard. A contractor can run every site from one place.

The supervisor checks in with GPS, marks attendance, and files a 5-minute daily report — even with no internet.

The owner and the accountant get records they can trust, faster wage calculation, and fewer arguments.

4.2 Top 3 MVP Value Propositions

Value	What it means
Verified attendance	The supervisor's check-in proves he was on site, and that attendance feeds wages directly. No more “he said, she said.”
A 5-minute daily report	Mostly taps, very little typing. Works fully offline. Replaces the register and the WhatsApp updates.
Transparent wages	Approved attendance becomes a clear wage summary you can export. Pay cycles get faster and disputes drop.

4.3 How to Think About the Product

Step	Who	What happens
1 · CAPTURE	Supervisor (Android)	Check in → attendance → daily report → materials. Saved offline, synced later.
2 · REVIEW	Project Manager / Owner	Reports and exceptions are checked and approved. Every correction keeps its history.
3 · CLOSE	Accountant / Owner	Approved attendance becomes the wage summary. Dashboard and exports keep everyone updated.

One loop per site, every day: capture in the field → review in the office → close the books. A weak network only delays the sync. It never loses the record.

5. Goals / Measurable Outcomes

What success looks like after the 30-day pilot:

Area	Target
Adoption	At least 80% of active pilot sites send verified attendance and a daily report on 5+ days a week. At least 60% of supervisors are still active after two weeks.
Efficiency	Daily report time: median 5 minutes or less and 90th percentile 8 minutes or less. Measured in the app as the elapsed time from opening the daily-report form to a successful submit, counted only for a normal report — no photo, fewer than 25 workers, one site — on a mid-range Android device. Taken from telemetry, never self-reported. Wage preparation takes 50% less time than the customer's current process, measured by timing one full cycle before onboarding and one in pilot week four.
Business	At least 3 of the 5 pilot customers agree to continue on a paid plan.

North-star metric: active sites with verified attendance and a completed daily report on the same working day.

6. MVP / Functional Requirements

P0 = must be in the MVP. **P1** = right after the MVP. **Telemetry** = what the product team must be able to measure.

6.1 CUJ-1 · First-Time Setup (Owner / Admin)

Priority	What the product must do
P0	Owner can create the company account and set the basics — name, location, currency (INR), timezone and default language.
P0	Users sign in with an email address and a password, confirmed by a verification link. The owner invites the team by email or by a copyable invite link, so onboarding never depends on SMS delivery.
P0	Owner can create a site with a map pin and a geofence radius, and assign supervisors to it. A site needs at least one supervisor to go active.
P0	Owner can add workers (name, trade, pay type, rate) one by one, or bulk-import them from Excel or CSV.
P1	A new company gets a first-day setup checklist, so it reaches its first submitted attendance within 24 hours without help.
P1	Phone-number sign-in with OTP, once an SMS provider is contracted and DLT template registration is approved under the TRAI rules. Deferred from the MVP because SMS in India is a third-party dependency with a multi-week approval lead time, and no MVP journey needs it.
Telemetry	Setup completion and time-to-first-attendance can be measured for each new company.

6.2 CUJ-2 · Start of the Day — Check-in & Attendance (Supervisor)

Priority	What the product must do
P0	Supervisor can check in and check out at a site assigned to him. Location is taken only at that tap — never in the background.
P0	Check-in and attendance save on the phone with no internet, show a clear “pending sync” status, and sync on their own when the network returns.

Priority	What the product must do
P0	Supervisor can mark everyone present in one tap, then change only the exceptions — absent, half-day, leave, overtime.
P0	If a check-in happens outside the geofence, the app asks for a reason instead of accepting it silently. A manager can approve or reject it.
P1	Supervisors get a reminder when attendance for their site is still missing.

6.3 CUJ-3 · End of the Day — Daily Report & Materials (Supervisor)

Priority	What the product must do
P0	Supervisor can file a short daily report — site, date and headcount are pre-filled — covering work done, blockers, a safety flag and the next-day plan. Speed is held to the acceptance criterion in Section 5, not to an estimate.
P0	Reports can be saved as offline drafts. Photos are optional and never block submission.
P0	Serious blockers and safety issues are clearly flagged to managers as soon as the report is sent.
P0	Supervisor can record material received and material used per site. The app shows the balance left and warns on low or negative stock, where a reason is required.
P0	A submitted report cannot be changed quietly. Any later edit keeps a visible history of the change.
Telemetry	Report completion rate, time taken and sync failures can be monitored.

6.4 CUJ-4 · Prepare the Wage Summary (Accountant)

Priority	What the product must do
P0	Accountant can create a weekly or monthly wage summary that uses approved attendance only.
P0	The summary shows each worker's rate, payable days, overtime, adjustments and total. Nothing is hidden.
P0	The wage summary exports to Excel or CSV, and the exported numbers always match what the app shows.
P0	Accountant can lock a wage period but cannot reopen one. Only the owner can reopen a locked period, a reason is required, and both actions are recorded in the audit trail.
P1	Payment status (pending / part paid / paid) can be tracked per worker. Actually sending money by UPI or bank is not in the MVP.

6.5 CUJ-5 · Review, Approve & Maintain (Owner / PM)

Priority	What the product must do
P0	Owner or PM can see every site on one dashboard: who reported, who did not, headcount, exceptions, estimated wages, low stock and safety alerts.
P0	Manager can approve or reject a daily report or an attendance correction, with a comment.

Priority	What the product must do
P0	Every correction keeps the old value, the new value, the reason and the people involved — a full audit trail.
P0	Roles are respected everywhere. A supervisor sees only his own sites, and the server checks every permission.
P1	In-app notifications for missing reports, pending approvals and rejections. WhatsApp and SMS alerts come later.
Telemetry	Adoption per role is visible — approvals turned around, exports downloaded, and where users drop off.

6.6 CUJ-6 · Offboard, Archive & Exit (Lifecycle)

Priority	What the product must do
P0	Removing a user or a worker never deletes their history. Old records still show who created them.
P0	A finished site can be archived and becomes read-only.
P0	A customer who leaves can export all of their data — attendance, reports, wages and materials.

6.7 Out of Scope for the MVP

Not in the MVP	Where it goes	Why it waits
Worker self-service login	Release 4	Only if workers repeatedly ask supervisors for their own record.
UPI or bank wage payments	Release 4	Moving money brings regulatory scope the pilot does not need.
WhatsApp or SMS alerts	Not planned	In-app notifications arrive in Release 2. Pilot invites are sent as a copied link.
Purchase orders and vendor management	Release 3 candidate	Confirmed or dropped at the Release 2 gate, not before.
Full expense management	Release 3 candidate	Would arrive as site spend under an owner approval threshold.
Projects and bill of quantities	Release 3 candidate	The MVP tracks sites, not projects above them.
Property sales, bookings and collections	Release 3 candidate	A separate business motion from site execution.
Accounting, GST or Tally integrations	Release 4	Only on demand. The MVP exports CSV and Excel an accountant can use.

Not in the MVP	Where it goes	Why it waits
Statutory payroll engine — PF, ESI, EPFO filing	Not planned	BuildFlow produces the summary an accountant pays from. It is not a compliance engine.
Statutory registers — Form XIV muster roll, wage register	Release 2	Held back until a real customer's auditor can confirm the format.
Stock transfer between sites	Not planned	No pilot demand recorded.
Gantt charts and advanced scheduling	Release 4	Only if customers plan labour more than a day ahead.
BIM or design tools	Not planned	Outside the operations problem BuildFlow solves.
AI summaries	Not planned	Adds no trust to a record an owner must rely on.
Continuous location tracking	Not planned	Location is captured once per tap, on an explicit action, and never in the background.
Languages beyond English	Release 4	Hindi and regional translation is enabled technically in the MVP, not translated.

6.8 Phasing

Phase	What is in it	Gate to move on
Phase 1 · Private pilot (MVP)	Every P0 above. 3–5 companies, 5–10 sites, 30 days.	Section 5 goals are met, and real feedback confirms the P1 gaps.
Phase 2 · Paid MVP	The P1 items: reminders, in-app notifications, payment status, self-serve setup checklist.	Paid conversions and repeat usage.
Phase 3 · Expansion (future)	The Release 3 and Release 4 candidates listed in 6.7. Nothing here is committed before a contractor has used the product.	Not planned in detail here. A fresh document when we reach it.